Silverheights School Council Meeting Minutes

Date & Time: Apr 22, 2026 - 6:30 to 8:00 - library

Hybrid Meeting - https://meet.google.com/chx-bcyt-pvr

School Council Meeting

> *"Parents play a vital role in the development and education of their children and in the success of schools. They are the most important influence in a child's life outside of school.*
> *Long after direct learning from parents in a child's early years gives way to formal education, parents continue to play a key role in student success through the attitudes they help to share and the direct supports they provide."*
>
> Ontario Ministry of Education

School Council Summary: https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/school-councils/

School Council Handbook: https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/school_council_chairpersons_handbook.pdf

A school council is an advisory body that functions within the parameters of Ministry of Education and Board policy. School councils provide an opportunity and the means to advise the principal and the Board on any matter pertaining to improvement of pupil achievement and enhancing the accountability of the education system to parents/guardians. The ultimate responsibility for the administration and management of the day-to-day operation of the school rests with the principal.

Item	Agenda Item	Duration	Person(s) Responsible
1	**Welcome** Present: In Person: A Chong, S McCracken, H Train, T Goudy, J Stere, A Schofield, L Tam, A Fraser, D Sanghvi, L Paetkau Online: K Davy Regrets: A Lucas, C Rainville, E Cooper	1 mins	Co-Chair
2	**Territorial Acknowledgement & Equity Connection** - Earth day, acknowledge we are on Indigenous lands, we are all treaty people, in spirit of Earth Day true environmental sustainability is inseparable from the reconciliation - Next 3 weeks they have an indigenous itinerant teacher to co-plan with teachers to connect to indigenous knowledge, in the library there will be a map that is 8x12m large for classes to come interact with at a grade appropriate level. Council members can come look at the map (Tues- Wed)	2 mins	Vice Principal (T. Goudy)
3	**Council Housekeeping** - Approval of Feb School Council Minutes - Approved	5 mins	Co-Chair (L.Tam)
4	**News** ***Community Partnership*** – Silverheights Neighbourhood Association - **Update** www.silverheightsneighnourhood.com - For more information, please email programs@silverheightsneighbourhood.com	5 mins	SNA Representative

- Drop in programs happening through end of April and May, Tues Wed and Thur is $2/night for ages 5-12 from 6-8pm and Wed is 5-8pm
- May 8th is Junior night ages 5-10, grass planters and pizza 530-8pm $5
- Trying to do youth dance on May 22 for grades 4-8 cost is $5
- Summer camp is pretty much full but there is space in weeks 1 and 6
- Leadership camp ages 12-14 that still has spaces only 2 weeks for this camp July 6-10 and Jul 27-31
- Instead of neighbourhood day SNA will be part of the Hespeler Reunion Fri July 10- Sun July 12
- Still accepting craft supplies, empty water bottles and toilet paper tubes accepted, and any other crafting items

WRAPC/PIC — 5 mins — WRAPSC Rep (vacant)

https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/

- WRAPSC Minutes

PIC Parent Information Night: Let Grow Panel Discussion
Wednesday, April 15 | 6:00–8:00 PM
Forest Heights Collegiate Institute

This session will focus on the *Let Grow* initiative currently being piloted in WRDSB schools. The discussion will explore how schools and families can support student independence, resilience, and confidence through real-world experiences.

New: Mini Grant Opportunity for School Council Chairs
As an added incentive, PIC will be offering **mini grants to a select number of School Council Chairs who attend the event**. The number of grants available will depend on overall attendance, so we strongly encourage registration to increase your chances of being selected.

Teacher Update — 10 mins — Teacher Rep (A. Schofield)

- Kindergarten on April 9th they had a fantastic time at the glowstick party in the gym, large success
- Pete Moss assembly happened today for Earth Day, he was very good and grades Kindergarten to Gr 3 enjoyed his songs, in the lead up to the event children learned about the birds in Pete's songs, some created instruments, he was great from a diversity perspective including everyone
- 1/2A has had parents come in and teach children, lunar near year, airline pilot, maple syrup tree tapping, olympic volunteer
- Grade 2 class has been creating instruments from recycled and upcycled items, drums and kazoos have been made
- Gym intramurals for junior and intermediate, they have included badminton 2 days a week at nutrition break and pickle ball which run through April, put in a request for gym equipment, filled out a form to replace old broken equipment
- Autism family support night went very well and was extremely popular, had 26 families join, 56 parents and staff including community representatives, Waterloo region family network, Sunbeam and Kids Ability, plus 25 children who came. Families could connect with each other, discuss shared experiences, successes and challenges, families gained ideas on what services are available and how to access them which was the goal in addition to building community among families. Gym was divided in half to be mindful of the neurodivergent children, one side was calmer activities and one side was high energy, 8 adults who were supervising the children, staff members who are EAs and

emergency staff, 3 teens as well to help volunteer for high school volunteer hours, pizza was offered and also were mindful of families who were fasting during Ramadan. More popular than they had been expecting, which cost a little more than what was originally anticipated. $500 was budgeted and the cost was likely double. It could be beneficial to do something similar again next year to incorporate families who would like to learn more or children with other special needs. Potential for another event in the future.
Suggestion from council member to have event be tailored more specifically to a certain topic, feels as if timing of the event wasn't ideal so perhaps it could be at a different time, ideally earlier in the school year
Q: Does the Board have similar supporting programs? Yes, but up to School Administration to determine suitability based on school needs & not simply for marketing purposes.
Q: Could this be eligible for PIC/PRO grant support? Timing for grant awards may not align with timing of the event (if held earlier in the school year). Yes, this topic fits with the objectives of the grants & could allocate annually.

Clubs- There is a form 'So you want to start a club' and there are lots available, chess club is starting in week, gym dance club will start, Application includes- where will the location be, who is the supervisor, how will this benefit the community, etc.

Notes from A. Schofield:

- Kindergarten
- On April 9, the Kindergarten students had a fantastic time at the Kindergarten Glowstick Dance Party in the gym. They danced along to their favourite songs, including "Golden" and "Waka Waka," and really busted a move to the early 2000s techno classic "Sandstorm." All in all, the event was a glowing success!
- On April 22, Pete Moss delivered an engaging Earth Day music performance. In the lead-up to the event, students learned about the birds featured in Pete's songs, practising their signature calls and trying to imitate them. Some classes also created instruments from recycled materials, which they proudly played during the final song of the concert.
- 1/2 A - Mrs. Agbaje
- My class has been having parents come in and teach us about something they do or their job.
- We had
- - a parent teach us about Lunar New Year
- - parent and grandparent teach us about taping trees and making maple syrup
- - a parent who worked online and creates admin assistants for India
- - an Air Canada Pilot
- - a grandma that was at the Olympics as a volunteer and works for skate Canada
- It has been so wonderful to have parents enter the classroom and for myself and the students to learn together.
- Mrs. Becker Grade 2

	- Our class has been creating instruments out of recycled and some upcycling for the assembly on Thursday. - Drums and "kazoos" have been very popular. - Junior & Intermediate Intramurals Judy Straatman - Badminton Intramurals for juniors continue Tues-Thurs at both NB's and Pickleball for intermediates. Both will go until the last week of April. - Request for gym equipment - I've also filled out a Google form request to purchase additional PE equipment to help replenish old/broken equipment, so hopefully you'll have time to review this and approve it 🙏 - Autism Family Support Night $500.00 - - very popular - - 26 families, 56 Parents & Staff (including community representatives) - 25 Children (8 adults to offer childcare, 3 teens offering support, Evelyn)		
5	**Principal's Report** ● Facility Updates: Flood- theme of the year is plumbing, still continues to be an issue, removal of water in various forms has been extremely problematic. Result of the floods recently is a real disrespect of the actual facilities by the students, still having issues with this, kids who are habitually vandalizing the washrooms which is costing a lot of money to the school and board and the pressure on our custodial staff is immense. Difficult to monitor student ages & discipline due to the nature of the vandalism. Message to school community pending via School Day to notify families/caregivers. This is the worst year for these occurrences. Ramifications are financial, from a plumbing and sanitation standpoint. ● **Welcome to Kindie Night** **Date:** Wed May 27, 2026 **Time:** Doors Open at 5:30 for set up. **Equipment provided**: minimum table size - two school desks put together & 2 chairs ● 5:45 - Doors open to families ● 5:45 to 6:15 - visiting with Community Partners ● 6:15 - Short presentation in gym ● 6:20 - Families visit kindergarten classrooms. Please fill out this google form to RSVP! https://forms.gle/qfyv7hub8yprGM567 ● Projected higher enrollment (>700 students, expecting ~1.3 FTE). Board has issued layoffs for ~80 positions across the region. Silverheights PS is in a hiring position. ● Earth Day, itinerant indigenous teacher had a good presentation, kids were excited to go outside and clean up, intermediates cleaned the sand, used push brooms and snow shovels and moved a ton of sand into the gagaball pits, every grade did clean up appropriate for their ages ● Teachers will engage in EOY (End of year testing). From a literacy perspective, using a tool called Acadiance and U-fly use to create supports for kids ● EQAO (annual standardized testing). Continuing practice to administer online testing for grades 3 and grades 6. May 6 to Jun 10	10 mins	Principal (J. Stere)

	provincial window of testing. Silverheights PS scheduling mid-May. ● Swim to Survive- Grade 3s starting next week ● Field trips will start to be planned		
6	**New Agenda Items** - Principal Profile Instructions May 2026 due by May 15 - SIL_Principal Profile Form_ May 2026 - School council Survey is due by June 5th - Grade 8 celebration, they are coming up with ideas for their celebration, kids plan most things on their own with a bit of guidance and voting, June 23 from 6-8pm	10 mins	Principal (J. Stere)
7	**Financial Report** - Treasurer Report - See Below - We have a financial surplus, if we actually spend everything that is allocated we still have, we likely still have $10-$12,000 Grade 8 door skins, 3x $1000- Approved $500 for Autism night funding- Approved Volunteer appreciation needs to be planned and budgeted for: Silverheights volunteer appreciation, can we include strong start, PAWS for reading, can there be child care? Do we do this doing school hours or evening time? We could host two- during school hours for pizza volunteers and the evening volunteer appreciation. $500 approved for this. Supplies for pizza committee- need to buy for next year Chomp saw- promotes Stem at a younger age than grades 7 and 8. $350, request for 10 of these, perhaps 8 would be ideal. $3000 proposed towards these. Approved. - 25/26 Requests for School Council Funds - Approved	10 min	Treasurer (S. McCracken)
8	**Subcommittees** **1) Pizza Subcommittee - Chair - K. Davey** ○ Members: ▪ Chair - Kate Davy ▪ Secretary - Heather Train ▪ Volunteer Coordinator - Shaun McCracken ▪ Pizza Procurement Specialist - Darpana Sanghvi	15 mins	Chair (A. Jones)
9	**Questions & Answer Period** Pizza volunteer appreciation to be scheduled after one of the last pizza days of the school year (Jun 16)? Google form to be sent to parent volunteers for StrongStart & Council for an evening social (Jun 16/17/18), using SNA drop-in play nights.	5 mins	Council Members
10	**Next Meeting Date:** Jun 3, 2026 6:30 to 8:00 in library		In-person & Online
11	**Agenda Items for Next Meeting**	1 min	Chair (A. Jones)

	The mission of the School Council is to work to ensure the highest academic achievement and personal development of all of our Silverheights students. Please complete google form: Agenda Item Request for School Council Prepare to send out a poll to strong start volunteers, school council, pizza volunteers for an evening in mid June that might work
12	Adjournment

Notes:

MOE – Ontario Ministry of Education

PIC – Parent Involvement Committee (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/)

PRO – Parents Reaching Out

SCIS – Safe, Caring & Inclusive Schools (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/links/safe-caring-and-inclusive-schools-scis-resources/)

WRAPSC – Waterloo Region Assembly of Public School Councils (https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/)

General Council Email: silverheightscouncil@gmail.com

Silverheights Public School - Parent Council

Financial Report Apr 22, 2026

	Debit	Credit	Total	Notes
Income 2025/26				
Pizza Sales- School day*		$ 68,000.00		*95% of Projected Forecast for Revenue
Domino's fund code*		$ 500.00		*Estimate based on 2024/25 School Year
Total Income:			***$ 68,500.00***	
Approved Expenditures				
Domino's Pizza	-$ 35,000.00			*Estimated Cost for Pizza Days
School Day Fees	-$ 1,360.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Field Trip Fund	-$ 6,000.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Grade 8 Celebration	-$ 5,000.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Breaking Barriers Fund (Admin Use) Field Trips, Spirit Wear, Athletic Wear	-$ 1,000.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
ASD Caregiver Support Event	-$ 500.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Self-Regulation Tools	-$ 1,000.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Floor Mops & Boot Scrubbers	-$ 985.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Spirit Committee - Kindness Month	-$ 300.00			Approved in October 2025 Meeting
Drama (Grd 5&6) - Wireless Microphones	-$ 250.00			Approved in November 2025 Meeting
Pete Moss - Nature Education Performance	-$ 550.00			Approved in November 2025 Meeting
Sound Trap Subscription - Grd 7/8	-$ 1,500.00			Approved in November 2025 Meeting
K2 Indigenous Learning Activity Supplies	-$ 75.00			Approved in January 2026 Meeting
Teacher Education Account (E-Way)	-$ 4,000.00			Approved in February 2026 Meeting
Cricut Machine Allocation - Library	-$ 500.00			Approved in February 2026 Meeting
Grade 8 Door Skins	-$ 3,000.00			Approved in April 2026 Meeting
Physical Education Request	-$ 2,600.00			Approved in April 2026 Meeting
ASD Caregiver Support Event - Additional Funding	-$ 500.00			Approved in April 2026 Meeting

Chomp Saw Expense	-$ 3,000.00			Approved in April 2026 Meeting
Volunteer Appreciation Events	-$ 500.00			Approved in April 2026 Meeting
Total Approved Expenditures:			**-$ 67,620.00**	
Pending/Future Meeting Requests				
			$ -	
Total Projected Available Funds:			**$ 880.00**	*Projected estimate*